constitutional protection of speech" in which "[c]ore political speech occupies the highest, most protected position"); *Hill* v. *Colorado*, 530 U. S. 703, 787 (2000) (KENNEDY, J., dissenting) ("Laws punishing speech which protests the lawfulness or morality of the government's own policy are the essence of the tyrannical power the First Amendment guards against"); *Citizens United* v. *Federal Election Comm'n*, 558 U. S. 310, 349 (2010) ("If the First Amendment has any force, it prohibits Congress from fining or jailing citizens, or associations of citizens, for simply engaging in political speech").

Although in the Court's view the statute applies only where the PKK helps to coordinate a defendant's activities, *ante*, at 26, the simple fact of "coordination" alone cannot readily remove protection that the First Amendment would otherwise grant. That amendment, after all, also protects the freedom of association. See *NAACP* v. *Claiborne Hardware Co.*, 458 U. S. 886, 911 (1982) (The First Amendment's protections "of speech, assembly, association, and petition, 'though not identical, are inseparable'" (quoting *Thomas* v. *Collins*, 323 U. S. 516, 530 (1945))); *De Jonge* v. *Oregon*, 299 U. S. 353, 364 (1937) (describing the "right of peaceable assembly" as "a right cognate to those of free speech and free press and . . . equally fundamental"); see also *Roberts* v. *United States Jaycees*, 468 U. S. 609, 622 (1984). "Coordination" with a political group, like membership, involves association.

"Coordination" with a group that engages in unlawful activity also does not deprive the plaintiffs of the First Amendment's protection under any traditional "categorical" exception to its protection. The plaintiffs do not propose to solicit a crime. They will not engage in fraud or defamation or circulate obscenity. Cf. *United States* v. *Stevens*, 559 U. S. 460, 468–469 (2010) (describing "categories" of unprotected speech). And the First Amendment protects advocacy even of *unlawful* action so long as that advocacy is not